

Gujarat Ambuja Exports Ltd

Concall Tracker · Q1 FY2027 (quarter ended 30 June 2026) · NSE: GAEL · BSE: 524226 · Report prepared 3 Aug 2026

Not investment advice. Do your own due diligence. An AI-generated reading of the company's public financials, annual filings, credit-rating rationales and news record. This company holds no earnings calls — see Section 2.

1 Snapshot

What the business does: GAEL is an Ahmedabad-based agro processor with two engines. The bigger one is **maize processing** — milling corn by the "wet milling" method (soaking and grinding the grain to separate out its parts) to make starch and a family of sweeteners and derivatives: liquid glucose, dextrose, sorbitol, maltodextrin and corn gluten. These are sold to food, drink, pharmaceutical, paper, textile and chemical customers. The smaller, thinner engine is **agro processing** — crushing soybean seed for oil and refining edible oil. It also runs a small cotton-yarn spinning unit and some renewable power. GAEL is **India's largest maize processor**, with roughly a fifth of the organised market. It earns its money on the **crush spread** — the gap between what the raw grain or seed costs and what the processed output sells for.

Measure	Value	What it means in plain words
Market cap	₹8,288 cr	What the whole company is worth on the stock market — a mid-cap.
FY26 revenue	₹5,729 cr	Total sales in the year to March 2026, up 24% on FY25's ₹4,613 cr — the best growth in a decade.
FY26 net profit	₹305 cr	Profit after all costs and tax, up 22% from ₹251 cr. Still below the ₹475 cr peak of FY22.
FY26 operating margin	8%	Eight paise of operating profit per rupee of sales. Thin — this is a commodity processor, not a branded business.
Trailing-12-month profit	₹417 cr	Last four quarters combined. 37% above the full FY26 figure — almost entirely because of the two most recent quarters.
Net cash (Mar 26)	~₹816 cr	₹1,256 cr of investments against ₹440 cr of borrowings. Genuinely debt-free, with a large cash cushion.
ROCE (FY26)	12.5%	Return on the capital employed in the business. Modest, and down hard from 30% in FY22.
Working capital days	96 days	Cash tied up in stock and unpaid bills — up from 56 days in FY24. Deteriorating sharply.
Promoter holding	63.84%	The founding Gupta family owns nearly two-thirds. Not one share bought or sold in three years.

2 Coverage

No concall transcripts were available on Screener — this report is based on a global web deep-dive

Gujarat Ambuja Exports has never held an earnings call. This is not a gap in the data or a scraping failure. The Screener.in page for GAEL was checked directly on 3 Aug 2026: its Documents area carries only *Announcements*, *Annual reports* and *Credit ratings*. There is no "Concalls" heading at all, and the word "Transcript" does not appear once. For a company worth ₹8,288 crore, that is unusual, and it matters for this report: **there is no question-and-answer record anywhere**, so no analyst has ever been able to press management on a missed target, a shelved project or a collapsed margin. Everything below is drawn from documents the company or a rating agency chose to publish.

Sources actually used: (1) CARE Ratings press release, 6 Aug 2025 — full text read; (2) CARE Ratings press release (Revised), 4 Dec 2025 — full text read, the single richest document here; (3) CRISIL Ratings rationale, 1 Aug 2025; (4) Screener.in standalone financial history — profit & loss, balance sheet, cash flow, ratios, quarterly results, shareholding; (5) BSE/NSE results filings and the company's results press releases for Q4 FY26 (May 2026) and Q1 FY27 (July 2026), including the segment tables; (6) exchange (Reg-30) announcements over the last two years — plant

commissionings at Sitarganj, Malda, Hubli; the Gujarat Pollution Control Board consent and the 9 Oct 2025 Gujarat Government MoU for Himmatnagar; (7) the company's own site, ambujagroup.com, and its annual-report / financial-reports section; (8) trade and financial press — Business Standard / Capital Market, ChiniMandi, Business Upturn, EquityBulls, MarketsMojo result analyses for Q2–Q4 FY26 and Q1 FY27; (9) independent analyst commentary on the capex programme.

★ Latest update highlights — Q1 FY27 (results filed 31 July 2026)

- **The best quarter in the company's history.** Revenue ₹1,594 cr, up 23% on ₹1,291 cr a year ago. Net profit **₹177 cr against ₹65 cr — up 172%.** One quarter delivered 58% of the whole of FY26's ₹305 cr profit. (Source: company results filing, 31 Jul 2026.)
- **The maize division did essentially all of it.** Maize revenue ₹1,085 cr against ₹796 cr (+36%), but its segment profit before interest and tax went from **₹37 cr to ₹190 cr — more than five-fold.** That is a margin of 17.6% against 4.7% a year ago. Thirteen percentage points of margin appeared in twelve months.
- **Operating margin 14.6%, the highest in seven quarters,** against 7.5% a year earlier. For context the same measure was **5% in Q2 FY26,** just three quarters before. This business swings violently.
- **The cause is the crush spread, not a strategy paying off.** Domestic maize (corn) prices began falling from Q3 FY26 while starch selling prices held. GAEL buys cheaper grain and sells the same output — the gap widened. Its own release credits "procurement efficiency", "product mix optimisation" and "selective price increases".
- **No management commentary beyond the press release.** There was no call, no analyst Q&A, no guidance for FY27, and no statement on whether the current margin is sustainable. The reader is left to judge that alone — which is the central difficulty of this report.

Business mix & capacity. Maize ~62% / agro (edible oil) ~36% of FY26 revenue — maize ₹3,566 cr and agro ₹2,089 cr, with cotton yarn and power making up a token remainder. Note the direction: maize was **73% of revenue in FY25 and ~70% in FY24,** so in FY26 the mix moved *away* from maize, not toward it, because the low-margin oil business grew 79% while maize grew only 6%. In Q1 FY27 maize recovered to 68% of sales. **Exports ~26% of revenue (FY25), down from 36% in FY24** and 24% in FY22 — roughly three-quarters of sales are inside India, and the export push that looked structural in FY24 reversed hard. Main export markets are south-east Asia, Korea and Bangladesh. **Maize processing capacity ~5,200 tonnes per day across five plants** (Sitarganj 1,950 · Malda 1,200 · Chalisgaon 1,000 · Haveri 750 · Himmatnagar 500), **running at roughly 82–90%** — so there is only about 10–18% headroom before new plant is needed. Also 4,500 tonnes/day of seed crushing, 1,200 tonnes/day of oil refining and 65,000 cotton spindles; 12 factories across 10 locations. The stated target is **6,000 tonnes/day,** via a 900 tonnes/day greenfield plant at Himmatnagar. (Segment splits from company filings; capacity and utilisation from CARE Dec 2025 and CRISIL Aug 2025 — GAEL does not publish utilisation itself.)

★ 3. Earning-trigger thesis

The public record tells a coherent story: GAEL is spending roughly **₹600 crore over FY26–FY28** (part of a wider programme of about ₹1,400 crore through FY28), entirely out of its own cash, to do two things — lift maize crushing capacity by about half, from ~3,500 to 6,000 tonnes a day, and shift the output mix from plain commodity starch into higher-value fermentation and speciality chemistry. Management's own framing, from the FY25 chairman's letter, is a move **"from Commodities to Chemistry"**. That is a real, funded, concrete driver, and parts of it have visibly landed: a 1,200 tonnes/day plant at Sitarganj went live in March 2025, a sodium gluconate unit at Hubli in December 2025, and a tripled maltodextrin line in March 2026. **But it is not what produced the last two quarters.** The profit explosion is a commodity swing, and the arithmetic below shows it beyond argument.

Mix shift or crush spread? The numbers settle it. In Q1 FY27 maize segment profit rose ₹153 cr year-on-year. Had the margin simply stayed where it was (4.7%) and only the extra volume come through, profit would have risen about ₹14 cr. **So roughly ₹139 cr — about 9 rupees in every 10 of the improvement — came from the margin widening, not from selling more or from a better mix.** Corn got cheaper; starch did not. That is the crush spread, and it is outside management's control. It moved just as violently the other way only three quarters earlier, when the maize division's margin fell to about **1% in Q2 FY26.**

Trigger	What the public record says	Evidence so far	Time horizon	Strength
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Maize capacity 5,200 → 6,000 tonnes/day	~50% capacity added over FY25–FY26; final step is a 900 t/day greenfield plant at Himmatnagar, ~₹100–250 cr, self-funded.	Part-delivered. Sitarganj (Mar 2025) and Malda are live and running ~90%. But Himmatnagar was still only at pollution-board consent and a state MoU in Oct 2025 — the 6,000 t/day date has slipped from FY26 to FY27 or later.	12–24 months	Moderate Real and funded, but the last leg is late and the industry has surplus capacity.
"Commodities to Chemistry" — value-added shift	Fermentation and speciality output to reach ~120,000 tonnes a year by FY28; sodium gluconate, maltodextrin, sorbitol, polyols. These carry ~15–18% margins against 7–10% on plain starch.	Genuinely executing: sodium gluconate at Hubli commissioned Dec 2025, maltodextrin tripled to 23,000 t/yr in Mar 2026, sorbitol at Sitarganj lifted to 220 t/day. But the volumes are still far too small to show up in segment margins.	2–4 years	Moderate The one genuinely durable idea here — and the one with no proof yet in the profit line.
Maize crush spread turning favourable	CARE noted in Dec 2025 that maize prices "have started to decline from Q3FY26, which should improve maize processing segment's profitability in coming quarters." It did — enormously.	Maize segment margin: ~10% (Q1 FY25) → ~5% (Q1 FY26) → ~1% (Q2 FY26) → 17.6% (Q1 FY27). Driving ~91% of the current profit surge.	1–4 quarters	Strong now, not durable A commodity swing, not a business improvement. It has already reversed once inside 18 months.
Export recovery	Both rating agencies recorded management expecting "revival in export demand in FY26"; exports had been talked up as a growth plank when they hit 36% of sales in FY24.	Did not happen. Exports fell to 26% of income in FY25 and no recovery has been disclosed since. GAEL does not publish a quarterly export split.	Unclear	Weak / unproven An expectation stated twice and never met or explained.
Fortress balance sheet funding it all	Net-debt free; gearing 0.08x; interest cover 25x; ~₹950–1,000 cr of cash and liquid investments; the entire capex from internal accruals.	Held through the worst of the downturn — GAEL never had to borrow, and CARE reaffirmed CARE AA-/Stable twice in 2025.	Ongoing	Strong Real, verified — but a cushion that lets them survive cycles, not an engine that grows earnings.

4 Management consistency scorecard

Read this first. On the concall path this table is built from management's own quarterly words, tested by analysts in real time. Here there is no such record. Every "promised" entry below comes from an annual-report statement, an exchange filing, or a rating agency reporting what management told it in a private meeting. That means promises can be quietly restated between annual reports with nobody noticing, and it means **this consistency read is materially weaker than a concall-based one**. Treat the verdicts as directional.

Period	Promised / stated	What happened	Verdict
FY24 (annual report & filings)	Exports scaled from 24% of sales in FY22 to 36% in FY24, presented as a structural widening of the market for starch derivatives.	Reversed. Exports fell to ~26% of income in FY25 on "trade and political uncertainties and increased global competition". Maize revenue itself fell 2.3%. No explanation was ever given directly to shareholders.	Missed
FY24 → FY25	Add 1,000 tonnes/day of maize capacity in FY25.	Done, and slightly better than promised — the 1,200 t/day greenfield unit at Sitarganj began commercial production on 26 Mar 2025, taking group capacity to 5,200 t/day and making Sitarganj India's largest maize plant.	Delivered
FY25 → FY26	Add another ~1,000 tonnes/day and reach 6,000 tonnes/day by	Not met on time. As of Oct 2025 the Himmatnagar 900 t/day plant had only a	Partly / slipping

	FY26 , a ~50% capacity increase over two years.	pollution-board consent to establish and a state-government MoU — construction stage, not commissioning. The 6,000 t/day milestone has quietly moved to FY27 or beyond.	
FY24 → FY26 (ethanol)	Diversify into grain-based ethanol: a 180 kilolitre-per-day plant at Malda, ~₹125 cr, environmental clearance obtained from the central ministry.	Shelved. CARE recorded in both its 2025 reports that "the capex plans for ethanol manufacturing have been put on hold due to expectation of profitability being lower than earlier envisaged." The approvals were won and then not used. Arguably a sensible commercial decision — but shareholders learned it from a rating agency, not the company.	Dropped
FY25 → FY26 (value-added)	Move "from Commodities to Chemistry" — build out fermentation and speciality derivatives to lift margins above the commodity-starch band.	Executing on schedule. Sodium gluconate (Hubli, 30,000 t/yr) commissioned 19 Dec 2025; maltodextrin expanded from 7,000 to 23,000 t/yr in Mar 2026; sorbitol at Sitarganj raised to 220 t/day. Too early to see it in the numbers, but the plants exist.	Delivered (on build; too-early on returns)
Aug 2025 (via CARE & CRISIL)	Operating margin to hold at ~ 8–9% near-to-medium term (CARE); CRISIL went further — 9.0–9.5% overall and maize margins of 12–14% once exports normalised.	Missed immediately. First-half FY26 operating profit fell 20% year-on-year and the maize division's margin dropped to 3%. By Dec 2025 CARE had cut its own expectation to " ~6% to 7% ... compared to earlier estimates of 8% to 9% ". Then Q4 FY26 came in at 13% and Q1 FY27 at 15%.	Missed — then overshoot
FY25 → FY26 (balance sheet)	Fund the entire capex from internal accruals and stay net-debt free.	Held. Gearing 0.08x, interest cover ~25x, ~₹950 cr of liquid investments, no meaningful term debt. Borrowings did rise to ₹440 cr in FY26 but sit against ₹1,256 cr of investments.	Delivered

Narrative drift. The core story has been steady for three years and is not drifting: maize first, value-added chemistry next, funded from own cash, no leverage. That much is to GAEL's credit, and the plants have genuinely been built — Sitarganj, Malda, Hubli and the sorbitol line are all real, on the ground, roughly on time. The drift is at the edges, and it is all in one direction: **the things that were promised but not fully under the company's control have quietly disappeared.** The export story was loud in FY24 and is simply never mentioned again after it collapsed. The ethanol diversification was pursued to the point of winning a central environmental clearance and then dropped without a shareholder-facing word. The 6,000 tonnes/day date moved from FY26 to FY27 with no announcement marking the change. None of these is scandalous on its own; together they show a management that publicises good news through exchange filings and lets bad news surface through a rating agency six months later. The most telling fact in this whole section is that in Q2 FY26 the company's main division earned a 1% margin, and **at no point did anyone from GAEL have to explain why to anybody.** A concall would have forced that conversation. There isn't one.

5 Bottom line — two verdicts

Durable earning trigger? → MAYBE

There is a real, funded, half-built driver here, and it deserves to be taken seriously: maize capacity up roughly 50% over two years, a genuine number-one position with about 20% of India's organised market, and a deliberate move up the value chain into fermentation chemistry where margins are 15–18% instead of 7–10%. Three of those speciality units were actually commissioned between December 2025 and March 2026. **But do not mistake the current earnings for evidence that it is working.** The 172% profit jump in Q1 FY27 is ~91% attributable to the maize crush spread widening — corn got cheaper while starch prices held — and only ~9% to extra volume. That same spread took the division's margin down to 1% nine months earlier. Two further things hold this back from a YES: the value-added programme is still too small to register in segment margins, so the durable part of the thesis remains *unproven at the profit line*; and the working-capital cycle has blown out from 56 to 96 days, which is why FY26 free cash flow was **negative ₹29 cr** despite ₹305 cr of reported profit. The strategy is credible. The current numbers are not proof of it, and buying the stock on a trailing profit of ₹417 cr means paying for a commodity spread at its best point in three years.

Management consistent? → MAYBE

Split the record in two and it reads clearly. On **what they control** — building plants, funding them without debt, holding a strategy — GAEL is good. Sitarganj came in on time and bigger than promised, Hubli and the maltodextrin and sorbitol lines all landed, the balance sheet stayed net-cash through a brutal margin downturn, and the "commodities to chemistry" direction has not wavered in three years. On **what they forecast or depend on others for**, the record is poor: the export share went backwards from 36% to 26% after being talked up, the 6,000 tonnes/day target slipped a year without acknowledgement, and the ethanol plant was taken all the way to environmental clearance and then shelved. **The bigger problem is the disclosure itself.** An ₹8,288 crore listed company that has never once held an earnings call gives its shareholders no forum to ask why the main division's margin fell to 1%, why ethanol was abandoned, or whether 17.6% maize margins can last. Every one of those facts in this report had to be pieced together from rating agencies and filings, months late. That is why this verdict is a MAYBE and not a YES, and it is also why the reader should hold this verdict more loosely than one built on transcripts — **there is no Q&A record here, and no analyst has ever been able to press this management on anything.**

Sources. Screener.in company page (screener.in/company/GAEL/) — verified 3 Aug 2026 as carrying *no* Concalls section and zero transcripts; standalone profit & loss, balance sheet, cash flow, ratios, quarterly results and shareholding tables from the same source. · CARE Ratings Ltd press release, Gujarat Ambuja Exports Limited, 6 Aug 2025 — careratings.com/upload/CompanyFiles/PR/202508120833_Gujarat_Ambuja_Exports_Limited.pdf · CARE Ratings Ltd press release (Revised), 4 Dec 2025 — careratings.com/upload/CompanyFiles/PR/202512121257_Gujarat_Ambuja_Exports_Limited.pdf · CRISIL Ratings rationale, 1 Aug 2025 — crisil.com/mnt/winshare/Ratings/RatingList/RatingDocs/GujaratAmbujaExportsLimited_August%2001_%202025_RR_373854.html · Company results filings and press releases, Q4/FY26 (May 2026) and Q1 FY27 (31 Jul 2026), including segment revenue and segment-result tables, via BSE (bseindia.com, scrip 524226) and NSE. · Company website and financial-reports/annual-report section — ambujagroup.com/financial-reports, ambujagroup.com/company-overview, ambujagroup.com/maize-processing, ambujagroup.com/infrastructure. · Exchange (Reg-30) announcements, 2024–2026: Sitarganj 1,200 TPD commissioning (26 Mar 2025); Malda unit inauguration; Hubli sodium gluconate commissioning (19 Dec 2025); Hubli maltodextrin expansion (28 Mar 2026); Sitarganj sorbitol expansion; GPCB Consent to Establish for Himmatnagar 900 TPD; MoU with Government of Gujarat (9 Oct 2025); MoEFCC environmental clearance for the 180 KLPD Malda ENA/ethanol plant. · Press and analyst coverage: Business Standard / Capital Market Q4 FY26 and Q1 FY27 result reports; MarketsMojo quarterly result analyses (Q2 FY26 – Q1 FY27); EquityBulls; Business Upturn; ChiniMandi; Whalesbook; independent analyst commentary on the FY26–FY28 capex programme.

A note on the numbers. Screener's GAEL page reports **standalone** figures, and those are used throughout (FY26 revenue ₹5,729 cr, net profit ₹305 cr; Q1 FY27 revenue ₹1,594 cr, net profit ₹177 cr). CARE's analytical approach is also standalone. The gap to consolidated is immaterial: consolidated FY26 net profit was ₹304.28 cr against a standalone ₹304.99 cr, and consolidated FY25 was ₹249.33 cr against a standalone ₹250.82 cr — under 1% apart, because the wholly-owned subsidiary building the food- and pharma-grade starch-derivative plant is not yet contributing. Some press reports have mislabelled the FY25 consolidated figure of ₹249 cr as FY26, which makes the year look flat when it in fact grew ~22%; that is a reporting error, not a discrepancy in the accounts.